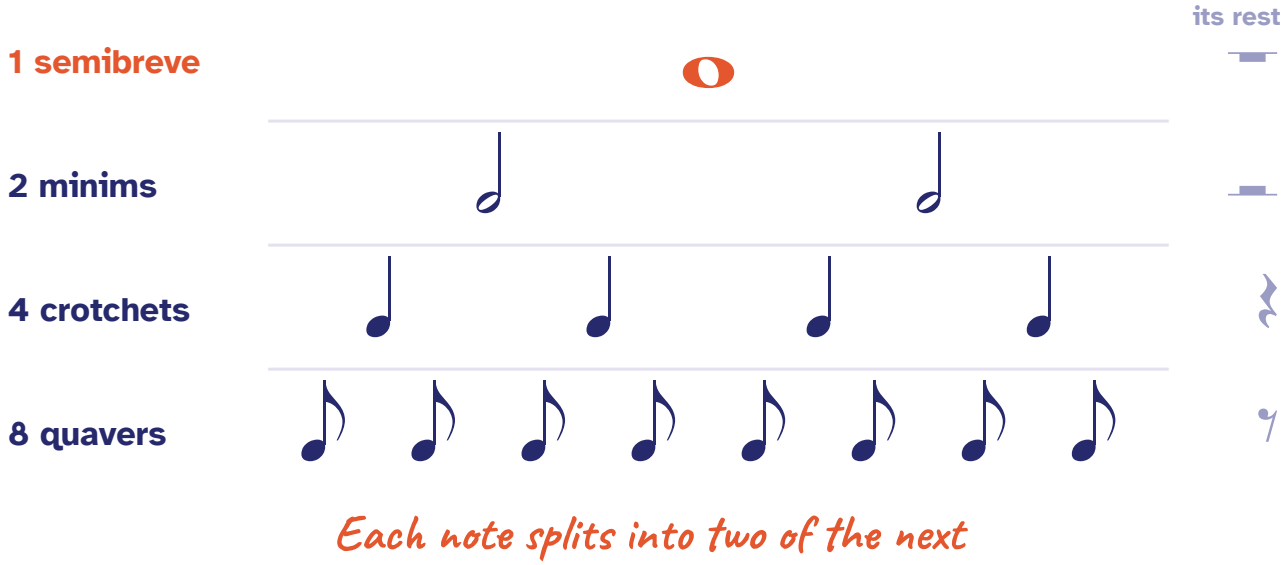
PART II · TIME · 2

# Notes and rests

You can see how long a note lasts from its shape: each plain note is **half** the one above it. And every note has a twin **rest**, a silence you count just as carefully.

**THE SECRET**

**Each note is half the one above it, and every note has a rest twin.**

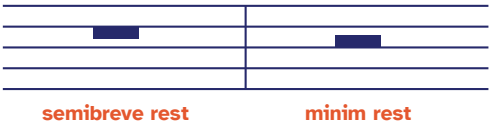



*Each note splits into two of the next*

## Head, stem, flag

The **head** sits on a line or in a space. A **stem** goes up on the right of the head or down on the left. **Flags** on the stem halve the value each time; groups of quavers are joined by **beams** instead of flags.

## Which rest is which?



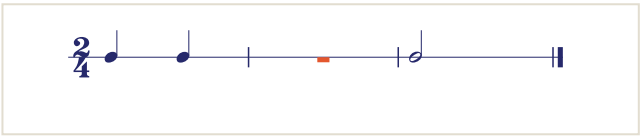

The semibreve rest **hangs** below the fourth line; the minim rest **sits** on the middle line.

**THE SEMIBREVE REST'S SPECIAL POWER**

Most rests last a fixed number of beats. The **semibreve rest** can also mean **a whole bar of silence** in any time signature: 4 beats in 4/4, but 3 in 3/4 and 2 in 2/4. It is then centred in the bar. No other rest can do this.

One more rule: keep the middle of a 4/4 bar visible. Silence on beats 2–3 is two crotchet rests, never one minim rest.





* With the crotchet as one beat, as in 2/4, 3/4 and 4/4. *Extra*: beyond Level 8.

PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

| NOTE | REST | NAME | ALSO CALLED | BEATS* | FIRST MET |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
|  |  | **breve** | double whole note | **8** | Level 4 |
|  |  | **dotted semibreve** | dotted whole note | **6** | *Extra* |
|  |  | **semibreve** | whole note | **4** | Level 0 |
|  |  | **dotted minim** | dotted half note | **3** | Level 0 |
|  |  | **minim** | half note | **2** | Level 0 |
|  |  | **dotted crotchet** | dotted quarter note | **1½** | Level ½ |
|  |  | **crotchet** | quarter note | **1** | Level 0 |
|  |  | **dotted quaver** | dotted eighth note | **¾** | Level 3 |
|  |  | **quaver** | eighth note | **½** | Level 0 |
|  |  | **semiquaver** | sixteenth note | **¼** | Level 2 |
|  |  | **demisemiquaver** | 32nd note | **⅛** | *Extra* |
|  |  | **hemidemisemiquaver** | 64th note | **1/16** | *Extra* |

PART II · TIME · 2 · CONTINUED

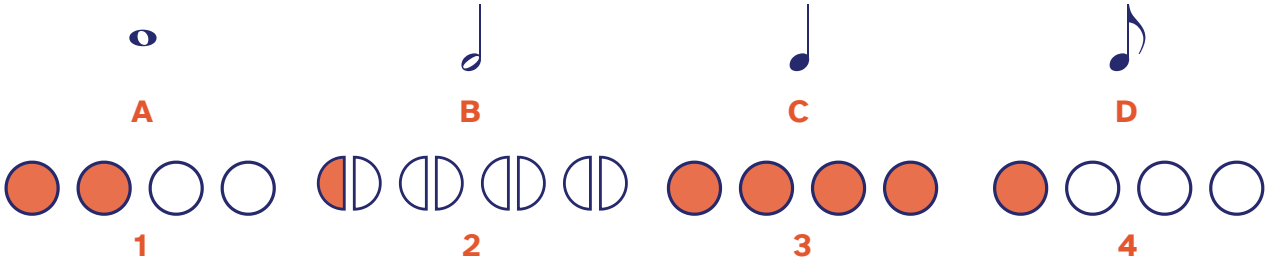
## Why whole, half and quarter?

Think of each beat as a pizza. A bar of 4/4 is four pizzas. The note that fills the whole bar is the **whole note**; the others are a half, a quarter, an eighth and a sixteenth of it. Two quavers beamed together fill one pizza. A rest is the same share left empty: shaded with lines.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **semibreve** | whole note | 4 pizzas · 4 beats | |
| semibreve rest | silence | 4 empty pizzas · 4 beats | |
| **minim** | half note | 2 pizzas · 2 beats | |
| minim rest | silence | 2 empty pizzas · 2 beats | |
| **crotchet** | quarter note | 1 pizza · 1 beat | |
| crotchet rest | silence | 1 empty pizza · 1 beat | |
| **quaver** | eighth note | half a pizza · ½ beat | |
| quaver rest | silence | half an empty pizza · ½ beat | |
| **semiquaver** | sixteenth note | a quarter of a pizza · ¼ beat | |
| semiquaver rest | silence | a quarter of an empty pizza · ¼ beat | |

GAME

### Pizza match




Match each note (A to D) with its pizzas (1 to 4). One pizza is one beat.

Answer: A 3, B 1, C 4, D 2.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



### Clap once and hold for 2: a minim.

Now clap four crotchets (1 2 3 4), then one semibreve (clap, and hold all four beats). Say the counts out loud.

SEE ALSO
Pulse and the bar p. 34 · How long is a note? p. 39

PRACTISE IT
Workbook Level 0 · Note values · Online: Library › Notes